

LECTURE 01

PAK. STUDIES

❖ Introduction to South Asia (Pakistan)

South Asia is a large region of the Asian continent. It is known for its ancient civilizations, rich history, and cultural diversity. This region has one of the highest populations in the world and plays an important role in global politics, economy, and culture.

➤ Countries of South Asia

South Asia includes the following countries:

Pakistan, India, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Bhutan, Maldives, and Afghanistan.

Although these countries have different religions and cultures, they share common historical roots and geographical features.

➤ Introduction of Pakistan

Pakistan is an Islamic republic located in South Asia. It was created to provide Muslims of the subcontinent a separate homeland where they could live freely according to their religion and culture. Pakistan came into existence on **14 August 1947**.

The capital city is **Islamabad**, which is known for its planning and greenery, while **Karachi** is the largest city and the economic center of the country.

➤ **Geographical Location of Pakistan**

- Pakistan's location is very important. It connects South Asia with **Central Asia, China, and the Middle East.**

Because of this location, Pakistan is important for:

- Trade routes
- Defense
- International relations
- Economic development

➤ **Physical Features of Pakistan**

- Pakistan has a variety of physical features:
- **Mountains:** Northern areas have some of the highest mountains in the world, including K2
- **Plains:** The Indus Plain is fertile and good for agriculture
- **Deserts:** Thar Desert lies in Sindh
- **Coastal areas:** Along the Arabian Sea

These features make Pakistan geographically diverse and rich in natural beauty.

➤ **Climate of Pakistan**

- Pakistan experiences different types of climate:
- Hot summers in most parts
- Cold winters in northern areas
- Monsoon rains during summer
- Climate affects agriculture, water resources, and daily life of people.

➤ **Population of Pakistan**

- Pakistan is one of the most populated countries in the world.
People belong to different ethnic groups such as **Punjabis, Sindhis, Pashtuns, Baloch, and Kashmiris**.
This diversity adds richness to Pakistani society.

➤ **Languages of Pakistan**

- **Urdu** is the national language and symbol of unity
- **English** is used for official and educational purposes
- Regional languages include **Punjabi, Sindhi, Pashto, Balochi, and Saraiki**
- Language diversity reflects the cultural variety of Pakistan.

➤ Religion and Society

Islam is the main religion of Pakistan, and Islamic values guide social life. People believe in respect, brotherhood, and helping others. Minority religions also exist and contribute to society.

➤ Culture and Traditions

Pakistan has a rich cultural heritage. Traditional food, music, poetry, and clothing are important parts of life. Festivals like **Eid-ul-Fitr, Eid-ul-Adha, and Independence Day** are celebrated with happiness and unity.

❖ History of Pakistan

➤ Ancient Civilization of Pakistan

The **Indus Valley Civilization** was one of the earliest civilizations of the world. Cities like **Mohenjo-Daro and Harappa** were well planned with roads, drainage systems, and markets. This shows that people of this region were advanced and organized.

➤ Arrival of Islam in South Asia

Islam came to this region in **712 AD** when **Muhammad bin Qasim** entered Sindh. Islam brought new religious, social, and moral values that influenced society deeply.

➤ **Muslim Empires in South Asia**

- After Islam, several Muslim dynasties ruled the region, including:
- Delhi Sultanate
- Mughal Empire
- The Mughals contributed greatly to architecture, administration, education, and culture.

➤ **British Colonial Rule**

- In the 18th century, the British took control of South Asia.
Local people were exploited, and their resources were used for British benefit.
This created feelings of injustice and resistance among people.

➤ **Pakistan Movement**

- Muslims of South Asia realized that their religious, political, and social rights were not protected.
Allama Iqbal presented the idea of a separate Muslim state.
Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah led the movement with determination and unity.

➤ **Creation of Pakistan (1947)**

After a long struggle, Pakistan was created on **14 August 1947**. Millions of Muslims migrated to Pakistan and faced many hardships. Their sacrifices made the creation of Pakistan possible.

➤ **Challenges After Independence**

- Pakistan faced many problems after independence such as:
- Refugee settlement
- Economic difficulties
- Lack of infrastructure
- Despite these challenges, Pakistan continued to progress.

➤ **Economy of Pakistan**

- Pakistan's economy depends on:
- Agriculture
- Industry
- Trade and services

The **textile industry** plays a key role in exports and employment.

➤ **Defense and National Security**

Pakistan has a strong defense system to protect its borders. It plays an important role in maintaining peace and stability in the region.

➤ **Role of Pakistan in South Asia**

Pakistan is an important country in South Asia due to its:

- Strategic location
- Military strength
- Economic potential
- Diplomatic relations

➤ **Future of Pakistan**

Pakistan is focusing on education, technology, and youth development. The young population is a great asset for future growth and progress.